SPACESAVVY · FREE GUIDE

The Small Space Checklist

Simple, renter-friendly steps to get more storage out of a small apartment.

Measure first (10 minutes)

- [ ] Measure every closet, cabinet and gap you want to use: width, depth AND height.
- [ ] Measure the gap between the floor and your bed frame.
- [ ] Note your desk or shelf thickness before buying anything that clamps on.
- [ ] Mark big furniture on the floor with painter's tape and live with it for a day.
- [ ] Check your lease: what does it say about nails, screws and adhesive hooks?

Use the space you're ignoring

- [ ] Under the bed: zippered bags or bins (add bed risers if the gap is small).
- [ ] Behind doors: over-the-door hooks or a pocket organizer.
- [ ] Side of the fridge: magnetic shelves for spices and wraps.
- [ ] Inside cabinets: shelf risers and turntables to use the height and the back.
- [ ] Narrow gaps: a slim rolling cart beside the fridge or washer.

Closet in 15 minutes

- [ ] Switch to slim, matching hangers. It frees rod space instantly.
- [ ] Use cascading hangers for pants and skirts.
- [ ] Add a hanging fabric shelf for folded sweaters and bags.
- [ ] Store off-season bedding in vacuum bags.

Renter-safe rules

- [ ] Prefer tension rods, clamps, magnets and freestanding pieces over screws.
- [ ] Clean walls with rubbing alcohol before using adhesive hooks, and respect the weight limit.
- [ ] Keep screws, hinges and doors you remove in a labeled bag for move-out day.
- [ ] Ask your landlord in writing before drilling, and patch holes before you leave.

Keep it from coming back

- [ ] One in, one out: when something new comes home, something old leaves.
- [ ] Give every item a 'home' and label bins.
- [ ] Do a 10-minute reset every Sunday evening.

Want product ideas for each step?

Our guides list renter-friendly picks with honest 'Watch out' notes:
spacesavvy-olive.vercel.app